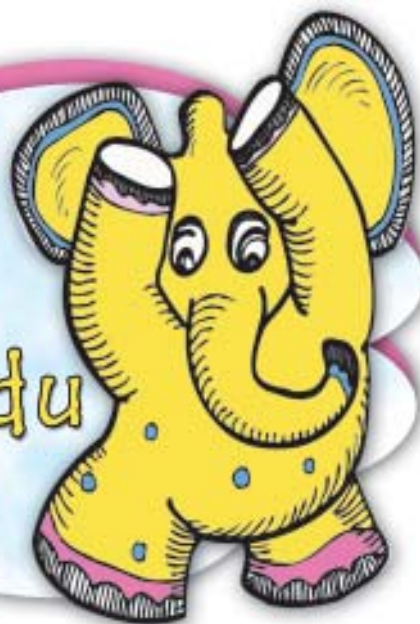


Chapter 3

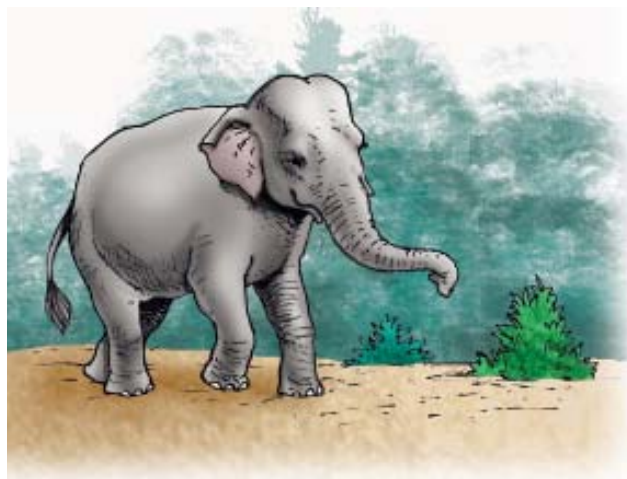
A Day with Nandu



Nandu Wakes Up

Nandu woke up and opened his eyes. For a few seconds he was not sure where he was. It seemed to him that he was surrounded by a forest of big grey tree trunks. He blinked his eyes and looked around. Oh! There was *Amma*.

The grey forest that he had imagined he was in, was actually the legs and trunks of his family members.



The sun was over head and it was getting hot. *Nani ma* trumpeted – made a loud sound. *Nani ma* is the oldest in this herd of elephants. She started moving towards the jungle. The other female elephants saw her and started to follow her. Nandu also went with them.

For the teacher: Mother's mother is called *nani ma*. Ask children what they call their mother's mother.

When they reached the jungle, the members of the herd started spreading out. Each member went to eat her favourite leaves and twigs. After they had eaten, the herd moved towards the river. The baby elephants enjoyed playing in the water. The mothers laid down in the water and mud on the river bank.



Do you know that an adult elephant can eat more than 100 kilograms of leaves and twigs in one day? Elephants do not rest very much. They sleep for only two to four hours in a day. Elephants love to play with mud and water. The mud keeps their skin cool. Their big ears also work like fans. The elephants flap these to keep themselves cool.

Findout

Ø Nandu is only three months old, but he weighs 200 kilograms. What is your weight?

Ø Can you find out – the weight of how many children like you will add up to Nandu's weight?



Fun and Games

Nandu saw his brothers and sisters pulling each other's tails. He thought, "I better not go near them. What if they fall on me? I am still small." He quietly went and stood near his mother.

Amma gently pushed Nandu towards the water, as if she was telling him to go and play. Nandu loved to play in the water. His cousins were already there. Just as he reached near, a strong fountain of water fell on his head. He got wet. Oh, this was the work of his naughty cousins. Nandu joined them in the game.



Before sunset, the herd started back towards the jungle. By then, Nandu was very tired. He settled himself between his mother's front legs and fell asleep as he drank her milk.

You have read about Nandu and the elephant herd. An elephant herd has only females and baby elephants. The oldest female is the leader of the herd. A herd may have 10 to 12 female elephants and young ones. Male elephants live in the herd till they are 14–15 years old. Then they leave their herd and move around alone. Nandu will also leave his herd when he is that old.

Like elephants, some other animals also live together in groups. These animal groups are called herds. Animals in herds usually move around together, searching for food.

- Ø If you were Nandu, and you lived in a herd, what kind of things would you do?

- Ø In the elephant herd, the oldest female elephant decides everything. Who takes decisions in your family?

- Ø Make a collage of a herd of elephants in your notebook. For this, collect as many pictures of elephants that you can. Cut out the elephants and stick them in the notebook.



A Day with Nandu

- Ö Nandu did things that he liked to do. If you could spend a whole day with your friends, what all would you do?

Ö _____

Ö _____

Ö _____

Ö _____

Ö _____

- Ö Find out and write, which other animals live in herds.

- Ö Do you also live in a group? Do you like to live together like that? What do you think are the good and the bad points of living in a group? Write them.

Good Points

Bad Points



- Ø Have you ever taken a ride on an elephant? How did it feel?

- Ø Which animals have you sat on? Write their names.

- Ø You must have seen many animals around you – in books, in movies. Some may be alone, some in groups. Find out more about any one of these animals and write about it.



Think and Write

Why do you think the egret is sitting on the buffalo?



ö Have you seen any animal riding on another animal? Write its name.

ö The animal which is riding.

ö The animal which gives the ride.

ö Which animals do we use for riding?

ö Which animals do we use for carrying loads?

Make Your Own Elephant

ö Copy the drawing of the elephant given on the next page in a bigger size on a thick sheet of paper.

ö Make small cuts where it says “cut” (✂) in the picture. Be careful not to cut off the part.

ö Fold along the dotted lines [.....]

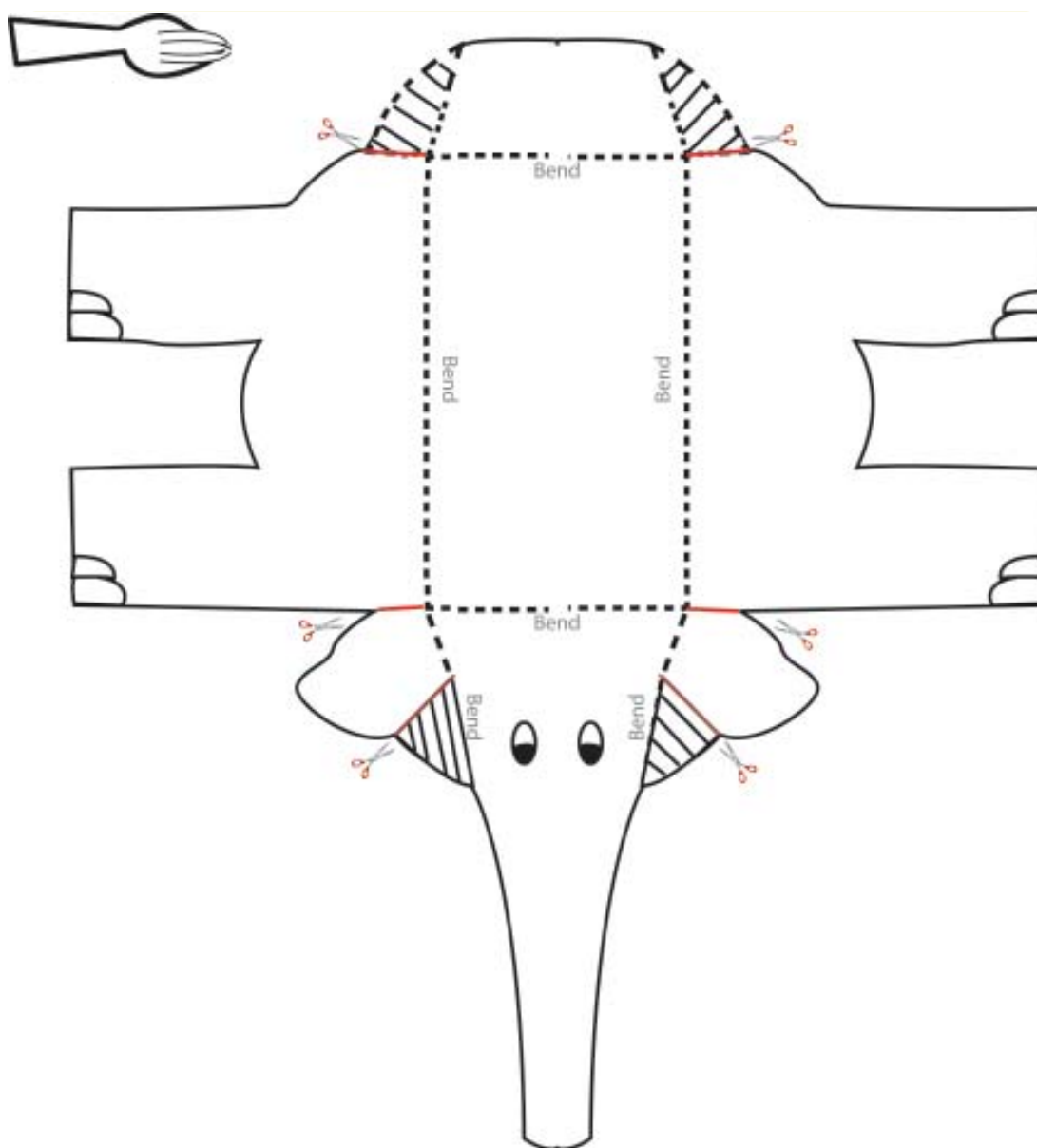
ö Fold the part with [////////] pattern and push them underneath.

ö Cut out the tail and stick it on.



Your elephant is ready.

- ö Colour and decorate it.
- ö Put up an exhibition in class of all the paper-elephants that you have made.



What do They Say?

- Ø Look at these pictures and read what these animals are sharing with their friends.



Discuss

- o You have read what these animals say. Why do you think that some of them are sad?
- o How do you think they are different – the monkeys that dance to entertain people and the monkeys that are free?

How many legs does this elephant have?

